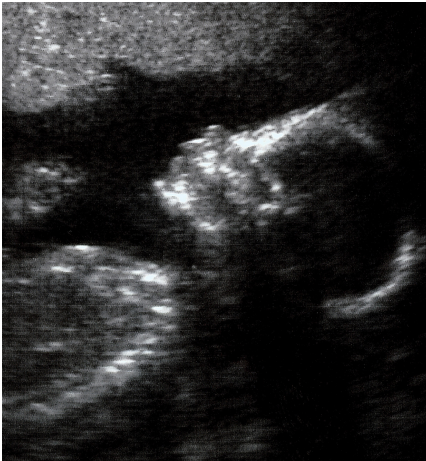




YOU ARE **24 WEEKS EXACTLY**
112 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

As your pregnancy advances, your baby's skeleton starts to harden, reflecting more of the ultrasound beam and casting black shadows. In this scan, the forehead casts a shadow, and it is no longer allowing the brain beneath to be easily seen.

“Even though you're well settled into your pregnancy, ensure you maintain all those healthy lifestyle habits you've established.”

You've been pregnant for almost six months and are, hopefully, feeling great in yourself. Don't, however, let this make you complacent. Even though your baby is well developed by this stage, it's important to maximize her health, and your own, by continuing to eat well and taking care of yourself. Changes, such as not smoking or drinking alcohol, will probably be part of your normal lifestyle now as opposed to something that you have to think about and work hard at. If you have not managed to change your lifestyle to become more healthy, then it is never too late to start. Any changes you make now will benefit both you and your baby.

While you'll need to adapt your exercise routine, if you have one, in these later stages, ensure you continue to be active and, ideally, do something physical every day, even if it's just a 20-minute stroll. Also keep up your daily [Kegel exercises](#)—once the baby is born, you'll be thankful you did.

FOCUS ON PARTNERS

Don't be afraid to talk to your baby in the womb. After birth, your baby will recognize your voice and this will have a calming effect when they are distressed. So tell them about your day and even read to them—it helps create a bond.

Male partners have a slight advantage over female partners, because to begin with, the baby will recognize lower-pitched sounds, such as deep male voices, more readily than the higher-pitched sounds of female voices.

HOW TO WEAR A SEAT BELT

Research found that over half of pregnant women did not wear their seat belt correctly, positioning it too high across the abdomen and putting the torso strap behind them rather than over the shoulder.